Microsoft Corp.

Evolving AI Offering Brings E7 to Office Range

As part of several product announcements, MSFT today introduced an E7 SKU to its Office line-up. E7 will combine the E5 capabilities with Copilot and Agent 365, and represents a clear up-sell opportunity. We like this move as it harmonizes the fragmenting Office plus Add-On landscape.

The Office Suite is one of MSFT's largest franchises, with over 400mn users. Seat growth has been one growth factor but upside here is limited (mostly entry level expansions), and hence capturing greater value has been the more important driver of growth. In this respect, we like the introduction of E7 today as it enables the continuation of MSFT's upsell strategy by bundling more value into an offering at a higher price point. E7 should increase investors' confidence that MSFT can maintain solid Office growth (currently around mid-teens level YoY) for longer. We also note the launch of Wave 3 for MSFT Copilot which includes the offering of Anthropic's models (beside OpenAI) and Claude Cowork capabilities and cements MSFT's role as a successful fast follower of new technology.

When MSFT launched Copilot a while ago, many investors asked why it was not part of a new SKU (E7 for example). At the time, it seemed MSFT wanted to make Copilot available to a broader audience (not just the high-end SKU customers) and hence the separate pricing. However, it does create friction in the sales process, especially for the enterprise level, if two different pricing agreements (an Office SKU and the Copilot commitment) and discount levels need to be discussed. In this respect, the new E7 offerings is just a natural extension. E7 includes E5 plus Copilot and Agent 365. At $99 per user, the offering is above the $60 E5 price (price update on July 2026) but is cheaper than the individual components (E5 $60 plus Copilot $30 plus Agent 365 $15). We note that in recent quarters, E5 was mentioned as the main growth driver for Office growth, followed by Copilot.

With its product announcements today, Microsoft also provides an answer for another recent investor discussion point around the evolution of work. When Anthropic launched Claude Cowork a few weeks ago, we received many questions about MSFT capabilities to innovate on its productivity offering and defend its position as the leading productivity suite provider given the newer AI players and their offerings in the space. However, today's announcement of the 3rd Wave of Copilot provides clear answers here. As part of the news, MSFT explained that it will use Anthropic's Claude models but also more importantly some of the Claudework capabilities (multi-step work). This confirms to us MSFT's role as a fast follower. The combination of the new

First Look

MSFT	OVERWEIGHT
U.S. Software	POSITIVE
Price Target	USD 600.00
Price (06-Mar-26)	USD 408.96
Potential Upside/Downside	+46.7%

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

U.S. Software

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capabilities with the requirements of trust given the huge corporate footprint should cement MSFT's leading position further.

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Primary Stocks (Ticker, Date, Price)
Microsoft Corp. (MSFT, 06-Mar-2026, USD 408.96), Overweight/Positive, CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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Snowflake Computing (SNOW)	Sprinklr, Inc. (CXM)	Sprout Social, Inc. (SPT)
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Microsoft Corp. (MSFT / MSFT)

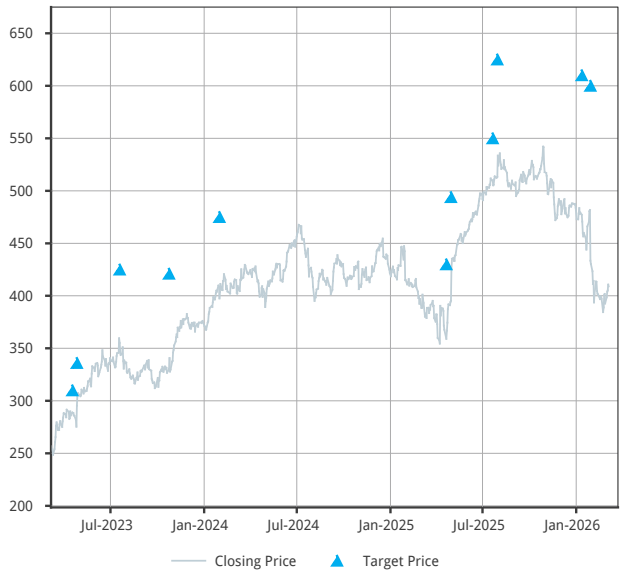
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **POSITIVE**

Closing Price: **USD 408.96** (06-Mar-2026)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 06-Mar-2026)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
29-Jan-2026	481.63		600.00
12-Jan-2026	479.28		610.00
30-Jul-2025	513.24		625.00
21-Jul-2025	510.05		550.00
30-Apr-2025	391.16		494.00
21-Apr-2025	367.78		430.00
31-Jan-2024	408.59		475.00
24-Oct-2023	330.53		421.00
19-Jul-2023	359.49		425.00
26-Apr-2023	295.37		336.00
17-Apr-2023	286.14		310.00

On 09-Mar-2023, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 280.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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